

6 280100 002330

WEDNESDAY
MARCH 4, 2026
RAMADAN 15, 1447



LIVE
UPDATES

Dominic & Partners

Partner for a better tomorrow.
Audit | Tax | Advisory

Branches: Dubai, Abu Dhabi, Sharjah, RAK and Riyadh, Saudi Arabia
Suite B 3001, Latifa tower, Sheikh Zayed Road, Dubai
info@domuae.com | www.domuae.com | Dubai +971 56 6040 648 | +971 50 9801 263

3545758.11

UAE STANDS UNITED AND RESOLUTE

Emergency air corridors activated to handle 48 flights per hour

ABU DHABI
BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor
DHANUSHA GOLKULAN
Chief Reporter

Four days into the US-Israel conflict with Iran, the UAE yesterday activated emergency air corridors handling up to 48 flights per hour, with plans to schedule 80 additional national carrier services to move 27,000 passengers in the next phase.

UAE authorities confirmed that essential commodity stockpiles are sufficient for four to six months, have shifted schools to distance learning, and have reinforced nationwide security deployments, as officials stressed that safety remains the top priority amid continued regional strikes and airspace disruption.

Taken together, the measures signal the UAE's steady move towards resuming normal operations while maintaining heightened readiness.

Air corridors

Speaking at a government media briefing, Minister of Economy and Tourism Abdulla Bin Touq Al Marri said, "The capacity as of today, based on the emergency routes available, is 48 flights per hour with a possibility of increasing this figure at a later stage, according to the latest development and security ratings and measures," implying, the UAE has created special emergency air corridors that can currently handle up to 48 aircraft movements per hour safely.

Al Marri announced that the UAE's strategic stockpile of essential commodities is sufficient to meet market needs for a period ranging between four and six months.

According to Al Marri, from March 1 to yesterday (March 3), a total of 17,498 passengers have travelled on 60 flights.

However, regular commercial operations of Emirates, Etihad, and Air Arabia are yet to resume. flydubai has begun limited operations. Al Marri urged affected passengers not to proceed to airports unless contacted directly by their airlines, in order to avoid congestion and ensure the smooth flow of travellers during this phase.

Sufficient stockpile

Al Marri announced that the UAE's strategic stockpile of essential commodities is sufficient to meet market needs for a period ranging between four and six months, thereby ensuring the continued availability of basic goods and price stability even under emergency conditions.

He affirmed that the UAE economy has consistently demonstrated resilience in absorbing pressures generated by economic and geopolitical crises, whether international or regional, maintaining a high degree of stability and efficiency. He attributed this resilience, in part, to the clear red lines established by the wise leadership with regard to food security.



X/DMO

■ Visitors to Dubai Mall were in for a surprise on Monday evening as President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan greeted them, while accompanied by Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council.

With respect to price monitoring and the availability of strategic reserves, Al Marri stressed that, under the guidance and support of the UAE leadership, this file has remained a top priority for many years due to its direct impact on

the stability of living standards for citizens and residents alike.

Life continues as normal

Dr Saif Al Dhaheri, the official spokesperson for the National Crisis and Emergency Management Authority, said daily life

UAE RETAINS RIGHT TO SELF DEFENCE

Reem Al Hashimy, Minister of State for International Cooperation, has said the UAE retains its full and inherent right to self-defence.

She said the UAE, along with other Gulf states, had made intensive diplomatic efforts to prevent military confrontation and curb further escalation.

Al Hashimy added that Iran carried out its blatant aggression without regard for the UAE's position. She confirmed that the UAE has taken measures including closing its embassy in Tehran and recalling its ambassador, as part of steps it considers necessary to safeguard its national interests and security.

She said the UAE's message is clear: the Iranian attacks are unjustified and have serious implications for regional security and stability. Despite the gravity of the situation, she reaffirmed that the UAE's approach remains balanced and guided by wisdom and restraint, while staying committed to protecting national security and maintaining regional stability.



IFTAR 18:26

Fajr	05:22	Shuruq	06:35
Dhuhr	12:33	Asr	15:53
Maghrib	18:26	Isha	19:39

IMSAK 05:12

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah



RAMADAN
CAR INSURANCE DEALS



800ALFRED

SPORT

'We back ourselves': Underdogs New Zealand eye final | P13



Subscribe In print and online

www.store.gulfnews.com
www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions
Tel : 600 587 234
E mail : circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE UAE: Dh 5.00	Bahrain: BD 0.500 Oman: RO 0.500 India: Rs 40.00	S.Arabia: SR 5.00 Pakistan: Rs 100.00
--------------------	--	--

HIGHEST LEVEL OF READINESS

UAE intercepts 186 ballistic missiles and 812 drones

ABU DHABI
BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor

The UAE is at the highest level of readiness and possesses the capabilities required to defend its territory regardless of how long the regional escalation continues, the Ministry of Defence said during a government media briefing yesterday on the latest developments.

Major General Staff Abdunnasser Mohammed Al Hammadi, the official spokesperson for the Ministry of Defence, said the UAE has advanced defence and armament systems, including national defence industries, enabling it to protect its land and people under all circumstances.

The spokesperson confirmed that since the beginning of the Iranian aggression, the UAE's air defences have dealt with 186 ballistic missiles launched towards the country. Of these, 172 missiles were successfully destroyed, 13 fell into the sea, and one ballistic missile landed within the country's territory.

Additionally, 812 Iranian drones were detected, of which 755 were intercepted, while 57 fell within the country's territory. Eight cruise missiles were also detected and destroyed. The incidents resulted in some collateral damage, including three fatalities and 68 minor injuries, as well as minor to moderate material damage to a number of civilian facilities.

The ministry stressed that the UAE main-

tained a diverse, integrated, and multi-layered air defence system capable of countering various aerial threats with high efficiency. These systems include long-, medium-, and short-range capabilities, ensuring comprehensive coverage of the national airspace.

Loud sounds

The spokesperson noted that the sounds heard in various parts of the country were the result of air defence systems intercepting ballistic missiles and UAE fighter jets engaging drones and cruise missiles.

He stated that these military actions demonstrate the full readiness and proactive plans implemented by the armed forces and relevant authorities across various sectors, enabling them to effectively and professionally counter different types of threats.

He further explained that, from a military standpoint, it is well known that intercepting hostile missiles and drones can result in falling debris, adding that all minor injuries and damages reported were not the result of direct strikes on targets within the country. The spokesperson concluded by affirming that, as a result of highly efficient and professional interception operations, the air defence systems successfully engaged hostile targets in a timely manner, contributing to minimising damage and preventing greater loss of life and property.

SEE ALSO P5

BEST BUYS

FROM GULF NEWS

The one-stop place to get all your shopping needs sorted!



Log on to
gulfnews.com/best-buys



1049660.11